

PRINCIPLES

1. Keep your rook and king on opposite colors from the enemy bishop.
2. Use your rook to cut off the enemy king's escape routes.
3. Coordinate your rook and king to control key squares and limit the opponent's king movement.
4. Aim to drive the enemy king to the edge of the board.
5. Be aware of the stalemate possibilities when the enemy king is cornered.
6. Use the bishop to control squares that the rook cannot reach.
7. Always look for opportunities to check the enemy king with your rook.
8. Maintain flexibility in your pieces to adapt to the opponent's moves.
9. Avoid placing your king in a position where it can be attacked by the enemy rook.
10. Practice the technique of checkmating with rook and bishop against a lone king.

SITUATION

The ending of Rook vs. Bishop is usually a draw, but the defender must be cautious when the king is pushed to the edge of the board. In this scenario, the black king is trapped in the corner, and the white rook can control the escape routes. The black bishop is unable to assist effectively, leading to a forced win for White. The position requires careful maneuvering to ensure the black king remains cornered.

FEN: 8/8/8/8/8/1R1k4/1B6 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White's objective is to force the black king into a corner while keeping the bishop from interfering. Black's goal is to avoid being trapped and to use the bishop to create escape routes for the king.

The position requires careful maneuvering to ensure a win for White.

STRATEGY

In this scenario, the winning plan is to force the black king into the wrong corner while using the rook to control escape routes. The white king should stay close to the black king, limiting its mobility. The bishop's role is to control squares that the rook cannot reach, ensuring that the black king remains trapped.

MOVES

Start by moving your rook to f1 to control the escape routes of the black king. If Black plays Bh2, continue with Rh1 to threaten the bishop. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Rf1 Bh2 2. Rh1 Bg3 3. Rg1 Bh2 4. Rg2 Bd6 5. Rd2 Be7 6. Rc2 Bf8 7. Rc8#.

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson highlights the dangers of pushing the king to the wrong corner (Principle 4) and the importance of avoiding stalemate when the enemy king is cornered (Principle 5). It also shows how to use the bishop to control squares that the rook cannot reach (Principle 6).